Standard Operating Procedure (SOP)

Country Specific Requirements Israel

Document Number: IQMS-94973
SSC-PTC-SOP-IL-014

Version: 4.0

Effective Date:	2026-01-09
QMS Area:	Quality
QMS Chapter:	4.9 Product Safety, Product Quality and Pharmacovigilance

Applicability

Bayer Level:	CH, PH

This document is electronically approved (signatures on the last page)

Distribution Sheet for Quality Regulations

Division/Business Unit ☒ PH ☒ CH

GBS Location
☐ Global Business Services Barcelona
☐ Global Business Services Costa Rica/Brazil
☐ Global Business Services Manila
☒ Global Business Services Gdansk
☐ Global Business Services India
☐ Global Business Services Dalian
☐ Global Business Services Germany

Region/ Country
☐ Global
☒ Specific Country: Israel

Relevance for R&D QMS
☐ Affected
☐ Interface
☒ N/A

Version:	4.0
Document Author(s):	Klaudia Lojewska (GPSTL)
Document Approver(s):	CQH: Olga Vaksman (GHSIW) PTC Leader/SME: Katarzyna Mazur-Kominek (GLISG)
Training Role(s):	GBS_GDN_PTC_CLUSTER 4
Relevant Process and Activities:	PTC

Table of contents

1 Scope and Framework 5
1.1 Scope 5
1.2 Framework 5
2 Abbreviations 5
3 Purpose & Set-Up 5
3.1 Purpose 5
3.2 General guidance 5
3.3 Roles and responsibilities 6
4 Specific requirements regarding PTC handling 7
4.1 Country Specific Requirements listed by different topics 7
5 Internal References 11
6 External References 11
History of changes 12
Annexes 13
Annex 1 13
Annex 2 14

1 Scope and Framework

1.1 Scope

Bayer Country Quality Units are accountable for a GMP compliant Product Technical Complaint Management within their respective countries. Within this responsibility they are supported by the respective Global Business Service in process steps like complaint initiation, classification forwarding for investigation to the RQU, and final approval including complaint sample management and reimbursement process.

This SOP defines clear guidance to the Global Business Service regarding all country specific requirements.

1.2 Framework

This SOP is based on principles and requirements outlined in SSC-PTC-SOP-001 “Manage Product Technical Complaint and Suspected Counterfeit Incidents in GBS”.

2 Abbreviations

AE	Adverse Event
CMO	Contract Manufacturing Organization
CQH	Country Quality Head
CQU	Country Quality Unit
GBS	Global Business Service
OTC products	Over-the-counter products
PTC	Product Technical Complaint
PV	Pharmacovigilance
RQU	Responsible Quality Unit

3 Purpose & Set-Up

3.1 Purpose

Country Specific Requirements for ***Israel*** are described in this SOP, regarding e.g. Data Privacy, Sample Handling Process, Reimbursement Process, Contacts, escalation rules.

During the processing of all PTCs by Bayer owned Global Business Service all country specific requirements are considered and followed besides the general complaint handling described in the SSC-PTC-SOP-001 “Manage Product Technical Complaint and Suspected Counterfeit Incidents in GBS”.

3.2 General guidance

The employees of Global Business Services follow the SOP during complaint processing in the complaint database on behalf of the Country Quality Units.

3.3 Roles and responsibilities

GBS team	- Enters PTCs, Suspected Counterfeit Incidents and Usability Issues according to defined timelines in a timely manner, entering them into the global complaint database in English language - Organizes missing information and asks CQU for any support contacting the complainant if not possible/allowed by GBS (e.g. data privacy, non-hosted language) - Performs the initial intake and classification of complaints after receipt - Informs the CQU about all PTCs where local authorities are involved, about all potential counterfeits and any other cases described in this SOP - Forwards the case to the respective RQU for further assessment - Checks if a complaint sample is needed and starts the process to organize shipping of the sample by contacting CQU - Reviews the case for plausibility and closes the complaint case in complaint database - Sends out standard response letters drafts to the CQU, in case it is requested by the CQU - Forwards all cases that are not PTCs back to the CQU or to the appropriate function for further processing
Country Quality Head (CQH) / Country Quality Unit (CQU)	- Is responsible for regular KPI evaluation to get overview of complaint activities at the GBS - Supports the GBS in organizing missing complaint information - Organizes the complaint sample and sends it to the RQU if requested. - Sends out the Response Letters to the complainants as requested and agreed with the GBS - Contacts local CMO on request of GBS as RQU to get investigation reports from the respective CMO - Ensures that all changes within the country law and regulation are directly notified to the GBS and that the Country Specific SOP is updated - Ensures that the current list of distributed products is updated and contains all products. - Anonymizes private data of individuals before forwarding initial information to GBS - Ensures the reimbursement and replacement process. - In exceptional cases CQU is allowed to enter cases with initial risk class high or medium, e.g., when GBS is unavailable, and it is known by CQU beforehand.

4 Specific requirements regarding PTC handling

4.1 Country Specific Requirements listed by different topics

Description	Assigned Roles & Document Reference
4.1.1 General Information In Israel the company operates under the legal entity Bayer Israel Ltd. Main office is in Hod Hasharon.	
4.1.2 Contact list Country Quality Head: Olga Vaksman *olga.vaksman@bayer.com* CQH deputy: Bat-El Darmon *bat-el.darmon@bayer.com* General e-mail CQU: *qa-israel@bayer.com* The general e-mail is used in the cases when the CQH or CQH deputy is unavailable, and it is known beforehand. **Remark:** Current name and e-mail address of CQH and CQH deputy are found on the QINT SharePoint: *https://bayergroup.sharepoint.com/sites/oneqint/SitePages/Who%20are%20we.aspx#country-quality-list*	
4.1.3 Escalation Rules The CQH and the CQH deputy should be notified via notification in the complaint database about any complaint case referring to at least one of the following situations: - Suspected Counterfeit Cases - Confirmed Counterfeit Cases (escalation via immediate action) - Any cases involving Health Authorities **Remark:** The current names and e-mail addresses of the CQH and the CQH deputy are found on the QINT SharePoint: *https://bayergroup.sharepoint.com/sites/oneqint/SitePages/Who%20are%20we.aspx#country-quality-list*	GBS
4.1.4 Pharmacovigilance cases All complaints are coming through Pharmacovigilance department, so all complaints are already verified for side effects. This department is acting as a call center. Contact to PV: *dsisrael@bayer.com*	GBS
4.1.5 Product Samples Due to Data Privacy rules, the sample handling process is in CQU's responsibility. When CQU sends an anonymised complaint to GBS it gives information regarding the status of the sample: "no batch, no sample' or "we will try to obtain the sample". Samples are either collected from the complainant or can be returned to pharmacies by the complainant, which are collected by a distributor and forwarded to CQU, depending on the case	GBS

Description	Assigned Roles & Document Reference
Samples can be announced as available, sometime after received complaint. CQU informs GBS about sample availability. In this case a follow-up complaint entry created. If a sample is required for investigation or requested by RQU, GBS contacts CQU via e-mail performing first attempt, CQU will contact the complainant by performing three attempts in 21 days, if possible, in order to retrieve the sample for investigation and document attempts of a sample request. CQU provides GBS with a result of sample obtaining (number of attempts and dates). If there is no response from CQU after 21 days, GBS contacts CQU to request information. In case the sample is missing, CQU provides the reason. Based on the received information GBS document the results of obtaining in the complaint database.	
4.1.6 Statement letter **Acknowledgement Letter when a complaint comes in:** All complaints are initially received by CQU and anonymized, GBS does not know any private data of the complainant, hence no acknowledgment letter is sent by GBS. **Response Letter after closing:** Response letters in English are created only if requested by CQU, while forwarding the complaint. Response letter draft is created by GBS using template response letter (Annex 2). GBS is filling the template with product name and final assessment (confirmed/unconfirmed). A draft of response letter is sent by GBS to CQU. CQU is responsible for providing the complainant with a response letter when required, at the discretion of the CQU. – Due to data privacy hard copy response letters are stored in fireproof cabinet in CQU, or as emails on the local CQU sharepoint, and not attached by GBS to complaint database.	GBS
4.1.7 RQU Contact list A table with all available products in the country, needed for entry into the complaint database, is available on SharePoint: go/ptcops. For CH products registration status in the respective country as well as Manufacturing Site are available via SYNAPS: go/synaps. List with the respective RQU contact names are provided by the Divisional Quality Assurance function and available on the SharePoint: PH: *PH RQU responsible list_HJ.xlsx* CH: *IQMS_MASTER LIST COMPLAINT RESPONSIBILITIES.xlsx*	GBS
4.1.8 List of Local Opportunities Products N/A	

Description	Assigned Roles & Document Reference

4.1.9 Data Privacy Requirements

The restriction on transferring data outside the borders of Israel are regulated in the Privacy Protection (Transfer of Data to Databases Abroad) Regulations, 5761-2001 (the “Regulations”). While the Regulations do allow transfer of data in certain cases (for example transfer to an entity located in the EU/EEA such as Polish entity), per Section 3 of the Regulations, recipient of such a transfer may not further transfer the data to any third party.

As such, when using a third-party service provider (such as a translator), the transfer of data from the recipient to the third party would be forbidden under the Regulations. Therefore, to avoid non-compliance with the Regulations our external attorneys advise that the Israeli Bayer entity transfers the data to the Polish entity in a manner that is already anonymized.

Based on the foregoing, complaints are managed only after anonymization.

Anonymization is performed by CQU via assigning internal reference number to each incoming complaint. The reference number will be added by the GBS in complaint database in the “Comments” field in the “Intake” section. No other data is entered in the “Comments” field to allow traceability.

4.1.10 Gathering additional information (including obtaining translation) — GBS, CQU

In case when the CQU receives a complaint firstly by a phone, then Product Complaint Form (see Annex 1) is used to document received information. The CQU sends this form to the GBS via e-mail as soon as possible, because timeline starts when phone complaint is received by the CQU.

It is allowed that CQU sends the received information in an e-mail as text.

After anonymization, CQU sends the complaint to GBS via e-mail, including reference number of the complaint. As the timeline is shared between CQU and GBS, in case if the date of awareness by CQU differs from the date the complaint was forwarded to GBS, the CQU notifies the date of awareness in the e-mail body. Initial Risk Class High and Medium complaints will be additionally marked as high priority e-mails, described as URGENT in the e-mail subject to expedite processing.

The complaints are received in Hebrew and rarely in English. Hebrew is not a hosted language, and complaints have to be translated by contacting Bayer Service Translation Office.

After acknowledgment of translated complaint, GBS checks the completeness of information. In case of missing information like batch number, sample availability, etc. (unless it was declared as unavailable initially), GBS contacts CQU and ask to contact the complainant for missing data, specifying what information is missing. CQU contacts the complainant to receive missing information performing 3 attempts within 21 days, CQU informs GBS about consumer response via e-mail. If there is no response from CQU after 21 days, GBS contacts CQU to request information.

4.1.11 Reimbursement and Replacement — GBS

Reimbursement and replacement stay in CQU’s and Bayer Israel responsibility.

Description	Assigned Roles & Document Reference
4.1.12 Mandatory Spot Checks for Translations For all countries where the complaints are sent out for translation to the translation tool, once a year mandatory spot checks must be performed. 5% of all complaint numbers per year should by checked by native speaker (based on random selection), e.g. CQU. Important is to check the “original income text” with “translated text” provided by translation provider. The GBS is the owner of the process and start this action. The GBS leads the process, picks the cases and provides report to the CQU. The CQU checks the translation and indicates the deviations. Acceptance Criteria: • No Major translation deviations • Total number of Minor translation deviations is less than 5%. . Deviations in the translation can be described as Minor or Major. • Minor translation deviations are deviations where a single word or short section of a sentence has been insufficiently translated, but the essence or meaning of the original message is still captured. • Major translation deviations are deviations where a single word or short section has been incorrectly translated (for example by the introduction of a new word or exclusion of a word from the original complaint in the translated version) which results in an incorrect essence or meaning in the translation of the original message. In case of a major translation deviation and exceeding 5% minor cases, the GBS will be informed promptly to open a deviation in the complaint database and to ensure appropriate CAPAs. In addition, the translation office needs to be informed.	GBS
4.1.13 Exceptions and special cases All complaints entered with initial risk class high and medium, the same as confirmed risk class high and medium, are closed by CQU after receipt of investigation, due to their responsibility as QP. In those cases, PTC officer after receiving investigation result, do usual plausibility check. If this check is passed, PTC officer document it’s result in Audit Trail and delegate in complaint database case for closure to respective CQU employee. Essure complaints will be handled by GBS, even though Bayer is not Manufacturing Authorization Holder in Israel.	
4.1.14 Others Additional local functions (such as, but not limited to: Digital Media Manager, Product Managers, QPs that are not part of the CQU and PV colleagues) can send PTCs directly to GBS via the designated email. This will be done only after those functions received appropriate local training and the training was documented, according to the local SOP.	

Description	Assigned Roles & Document Reference
In case additional information is needed for those cases, GBS will contact CQU (with the addition of the initial e-mail).	

5 Internal References

- SSC-PTC-SOP-001 “Manage Product Technical Complaints and Suspected Counterfeit Incidents in GBS”

6 External References

- N/A

History of changes

Version	Significant changes with respect to previous version	Effective Date *(yyyy-mm-dd)*
1	New document	2020-03-13
2	#Document is updated according to SSC-PTC-BP-002 "Country specific SOP template". # Chapter 3.3. GBS responsibilities updated # Chapter 4.1.6 Escalation rules updated # Format of "Applicability sheet" was updated and renamed to "Distribution sheet" # Change in document numbering form SSC-SOP-IL-014 to SSC-PTC-SOP-IL-014 # Chapter 4.1.2 Contact List is updated # Chapter 4.1.5 Product Samples is updated # Chapter 4.1.10 Gathering additional information is updated # Change of the abbreviations SSC and SSCDN into GBS according to new strategy.	2022-12-01
3	# Updated according to SSC-PTC-BP-002 “Country specific SOP template” version 5.0 # Chapter 4.1.5 and 4.1.6 wording adjusted. # Chapter 4.1.9 Information about remark field updated. # Chapter 4.1.11 Responsible unit changed from GBS to CQU	2024-10-31
4	# Distribution sheet updated # Training role updated # Through the document, “Dev@Com” replaced by “Complaint Database” Roles and responsibilities updated based on SSC-PTC-SOP-001 v.6.0 # Section 4.1.2 Reference to QINT SharePoint updated # Section 4.1.3 Escalation rules: escalation on initial risk category removed, escalation regarding final risk categories changed to high and medium according to SSC-PTC-SOP-001 v.6.0. Reference to QINT SharePoint updated. #Section 4.1.5 Updated the method of communication to receive information about the sample # Section 4.1.7 Updated references to global lists with RQU names for PH and CH	See coversheet

Annexes

Annex 1

Product Complaint Form

Complaint created (date)……
Complaint received (date) ……

Product information:	
Product name	
Batch / lot number	
Dosage form *(cream, tablet, capsule, etc.)*	
Package type/size	
Number of packages	
Sample available?*	Yes/No
*Sample available = please keep for further potential shipment	

Complaint information:	
Complaint description (defect description, is it suspected counterfeit case, etc.)	
Adverse event reported?	Yes/No
Does the complainant expect a response from Bayer?**	
**By requesting a response, the Complainant agrees to his/hers contact data being processed by Bayer for the purpose of providing the answer to the submitted complaint *(the exact sounding to be aligned with legal)*	

Complainants' contact information attention: in the countries with special Data Privacy regulations to be replaced by the complainant code number (to be given by CQU)	
Name and surname	
E-mail address	
Telephone	
Home address	

Sender (if other than Complainant, e.g. a pharmacy)	
Senders' Name (Legal entity)	
Address	
E-Mail address	
Telephone number	

Any additional information	

Annex 2



Annex2.docx

Task: Content Approval Verdict: Approve changes & release Approval to be made Effective	Olga Vaksman (olga.vaksman@bayer.com) Approver - Content 25-Dec-2025 07:45:55 GMT+0000
Task: Final Approval Verdict: Approve changes & release Final Approval to be made Effective	katarzyna mazur kominek (katarzyna.mazur-kominek@bayer.com) Approver 07-Jan-2026 09:24:10 GMT+0000